ELLIS Winter School 2026:
AI for Earth System, Hazards & Climate Extremes

16 - 20 March, 2026
National Technical University of Athens

Patission Complex

PROGRAMME

MONDAY 16/3

14:00 - 14:45
Keynote

"Operational tools and European Projects related to new technologies, science and AI in Hellenic Fire Service"
Zisoula Ntasiou
Fire Colonel, Hellenic Fire Service
Venue 1

14:45 - 17:45
Challenges - Group Work

Mikhail Ivanov, Arianna Olivelli, Marta Sapena, Vitus Benson, Said Ouala, Angelos Zavras
Amphitheater

Fangfei "Fei" Lan, Aishwarya Venkataramanan, Mohanad Albughdadi, Nikolaos-Ioannis Bountos, Emiliano Díaz Salas-Porras, Homer Durand
Venue 1

Nathan Mankovich, Reda El Ghawi, Sujan Koirala, Alexander Winkler, Nikolas Papadopoulos, Xu Shan
Venue 2

17:45 - 18:00
Challenges - Group Work
Reflection

18:00 - 20:00
Cocktail Ice Breaker

TUESDAY 17/3

15:00 - 15:45
Career Panel

- Prof. Gustau Camp-Valls, University of Valencia
- Sabrina Ricci, AI Ecosystem Coordinator, ESA phi-lab
- Assistant Prof. Maria Vakalopoulou, University Paris-Saclay
- Assistant Prof. Nico Lang, University of Copenhagen
- Dr. Dominik Schumacher, ETH
- Dr. Fangfei "Fei" Lan, University of Lausanne
- Anastasia Sarelli, OroraTech
- Dr. Christina Karakizi, Ministry of Digital Governance & Hellenic Space Center (Moderator)
- Dimitrios Bliziotis, Ministry of Digital Governance & Hellenic Space Center (Moderator)

15:45 - 16:30
Career Workshop

16:30 - 17:15
Coffee Break

17:15 - 17:30
Reflection

17:30 - 20:00
Greek Music Night

Please note that all Tuesday proceedings will take place in Lavrion

WEDNESDAY 18/3

14:00 - 14:45
Keynote

"Learning representations for global ecosystem modelling"
Assistant Prof. Nico Lang
University of Copenhagen
Venue 1

14:45 - 17:45
Challenges - Group Work

Mikhail Ivanov, Arianna Olivelli, Marta Sapena, Vitus Benson, Said Ouala, Angelos Zavras
Amphitheater

Fangfei "Fei" Lan, Aishwarya Venkataramanan, Mohanad Albughdadi, Nikolaos-Ioannis Bountos, Emiliano Díaz Salas-Porras, Homer Durand
Venue 1

Nathan Mankovich, Reda El Ghawi, Sujan Koirala, Alexander Winkler, Nikolas Papadopoulos, Xu Shan
Venue 2

17:45 - 18:00
Challenges - Group Work
Reflection

18:00 - 20:00
Stargazing at the National Observatory of Athens

THURSDAY 19/3

14:00 - 14:45
Keynote

"Breaking Silos. Building Systems. Science-Based, Stakeholder Co-Designed, Transformation Pathways"
Prof. Phoebe Koundouri
AUEB, Cambridge University, AthenaRC, UN SDSN Global Climate Hub
Venue 1

14:45 - 17:45
Challenges - Group Work

Mikhail Ivanov, Arianna Olivelli, Marta Sapena, Vitus Benson, Said Ouala, Angelos Zavras
Amphitheater

Fangfei "Fei" Lan, Aishwarya Venkataramanan, Mohanad Albughdadi, Nikolaos-Ioannis Bountos, Emiliano Díaz Salas-Porras, Homer Durand
Venue 1

Nathan Mankovich, Reda El Ghawi, Sujan Koirala, Alexander Winkler, Nikolas Papadopoulos, Xu Shan
Venue 2

17:45 - 18:00
Challenges - Group Work
Reflection

18:00 - 20:00
Bar Hopping & Athens Tour

FRIDAY 20/3

12:00 - 12:30
ESA Workshop

"The New Architectures of Earth Observation"
Mounia El Baz
EO Digital Innovation Engineer, ESA phi-Lab
Venue 1

12:30 - 14:00
Lunch & Poster Session
Venue 1

14:00 - 16:15
Challenges - Group Presentations
Venue 1

16:15 - 17:45
Awards & Closing Remarks
Venue 1

All times are in local Greece time (EET)

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